

BYLAWS AND POLICY

Amended and approved by the General Assembly on January 11, 2026



PENIEL BAPTIST CHURCH

(Voluntarily affiliated with the Southern Baptist Convention)
Tulsa, Oklahoma

Motto

“Reach and Teach with Jesus’ Compassion.”

mission statement

“Peniel Baptist Church is committed and participating in reaching the people and teaching the Gospel with Jesus’ compassion.”

Vision Statement

Peniel Baptist Church aims to build up strong missional church for evangelism works to accomplish the Great Commission of Jesus Christ.”

ARTICLE I

Name and principal office

The name of the Corporation is PENIEL BAPTIST CHURCH. This corporation will be further referred to in the Bylaws as the “Church.” The Church maintains its principal office at 2140 S 67th E Ave. Tulsa, Oklahoma 74129. The Church Executive of the Church shall have full power and authority to change the principal office from one location to another by adopting a resolution. The Secretary of the Church shall record any change of this location on these Bylaws, or this ARTICLE may be amended to state the new location.

ARTICLE II

Purpose

The purpose of the Church is to glorify God by fulfilling the Great Commandment (Matthew 22:36-40) and the Great Commission (Matthew 28:18-20) in accordance with the following biblical principles: Worship, Evangelism, Ministry, Discipleship, and Fellowship. The Church also seeks to benefit everyone (and the Asian emigrants in particular) in the Tulsa Metropolitan Area by providing opportunities for spiritual, physical, social, and cultural development. (Luke 2:52).

The Church, PBC treated everyone equally and do not entertain any type of discrimination based on race, color, national origin, disability, age, and sex.

ARTICLE III

Statement of Faith

We affirm the Holy Bible as the inspired Word of God and as the only basis for our beliefs. This Church accepts “The Baptist Faith and Message,” in its most recent form as adopted by the Southern Baptist Convention, as a general statement of our faith.

ARTICLE IV

Affiliation

This Church PBC is voluntarily affiliated to the Southern Baptist Convention, Baptist General Convention of Oklahoma, and the Tulsa Metro Baptist Networks and it is an autonomous and maintains the right to govern its own affairs. Recognizing, however, the benefits of cooperation with other churches, this Church voluntarily affiliates with the Southern Baptist Convention, the Baptist General Convention of Oklahoma, and the Tulsa Metro Baptist Association.

ARTICLE V

Description of PBC Logo

- a) **Globe:** Globe is a representation of the almighty God's dominion over the universe. A God who is imminent in nature yet transcending all oppositions and imperfection in the universe and humankind. It also speaks of the unchanging and eternal truth existing since creation, obtainable to everyone who seeks it. Globe also signifies the field where the church needs to reach out with the gospel.
- b) **Cross:** Cross is the principal representation of the Christians, drawing believers into the crucifixion of Jesus, reminding the benefits of Christ's redemption. In other term, the cross is a symbol of Jesus Himself and the Christian's faith.
- c) **Bible:** The foundation of the church is the Bible, the word of God. It is shown open, which mean the Bible should be read and put into practice by the church.
- d) **Fire:** Fire is associated with God and the Holy Spirit's eternal presence and power, often serves as a divine judgment and purification. Fire also gives light to the darkness.
- e) **Hands/Palm:** Hands open is a symbol of worship to God and is a representation of giving to God's ministry and to the needy. Hands confer authority, the church believe that one must be called by God for ministry, conferred by laying on of hands and commission by those who are in authority to preach the Gospel and administer in the ordinances thereof.

ARTICLE VI

Membership

SECTION 1: General

Membership in this Church shall consist of all people who have met the qualifications for membership and are listed on the membership rolls.

SECTION 2: Qualifications for Membership

- a) There shall be four qualifications for membership in the Church:
- b) A personal commitment of faith in Jesus Christ for salvation.
- c) Baptism by immersion as a testimony of salvation.
- d) Completion of the Church's membership class (orientation), the membership class/or orientation shall be conducted by the church executive; and
- e) A commitment to abide by the Membership Covenant.

SECTION 3: Designation of Membership

To reflect the membership of the Church properly and accurately, three rolls shall be maintained as follows:

- a) **Voting Members:** All members who are currently active in the Church and are eighteen years old or older.
- b) **Non-Voting Members:** All people who have met all the qualifications for membership but have not yet attained the age of eighteen years shall become non-voting members of the Church. Upon their eighteenth birthday, non-voting members shall automatically become voting members.
- c) **Inactive Members:** Members who have become inactive as determined by the Pastors.

- d) Voting members will be, hereafter, referred to in these Bylaws as “Members.” Any applicable reference to stockholders or members in the Oklahoma General Corporation Act shall be construed to refer to the voting members of the Church.

SECTION 4: Membership Covenant

The responsibilities of membership are described in the Membership Covenant as follows:

Membership Covenant

“Having received Christ as my Lord and Savior and been scripturally baptized, and agreeing with Peniel Baptist Church’s statements, strategy, and structure, I now feel led by the Holy Spirit to unite with the Peniel Baptist Church family. In doing so, I commit myself to God and to the other members to do the following:

1. I WILL PROTECT THE UNITY OF MY CHURCH

- a) By acting in love toward other believers: “May the God who gives endurance and encouragement give you a spirit of unity among yourselves as you follow Christ Jesus,” Rom 15:5
- b) “Now that you have purified yourselves by obeying the truth so that you have sincere love for your brothers, love one another deeply, from the heart.” 1 Peter 1:22.
- c) “Finally, all of you, live in harmony with one another; be sympathetic, love as brothers, be compassionate and humble.” 1 Peter 3:8
- d) By refusing to gossip: “Do not let any unwholesome talk come out of your mouths, but only what is helpful for building others up according to their needs, that it may benefit those who listen.” Eph 4:29
- e) By following the leaders: “Obey your leaders and submit to their authority. They keep watch over you as men who must give an account. Obey them so that their work will be a joy, not a burden, for that would be of no advantage to you.” Heb 13:17

2. I WILL SHARE THE RESPONSIBILITY OF MY CHURCH

- a) By praying for its growth: “We always thank God for all of you, mentioning you in our prayers.” 1 Thess 1:2 “I always pray with joy because of your partnership in the gospel from the first day until now” Phil 1:4,5
- b) By inviting the unchurched to attend: “Then the master told his servant, ‘Go out to the roads and country lanes and make them come in, so that my house will be full’” Luke 14:23
- c) By warmly welcoming those who visit: “Accept one another, then, just as Christ accepted you, in order to bring praise to God.” Rom 15:7

3. I WILL SERVE THE MINISTRY OF MY CHURCH

- a) By discovering my gifts and talents: “Each one should use whatever gift he has received to serve others, faithfully administering God’s grace in its various forms.” 1 Peter 4:10
- b) By being equipped to serve by my pastors: “It was He who gave some to be apostles, some to be prophets, some to be evangelists, and some to be pastors and teachers, to prepare God’s people for works of service, so that the body of Christ may be built up” Eph 4:11-12

- c) By developing a servant's heart: "Do nothing out of selfish ambition or vain conceit, but in humility consider others better than yourselves. Each of you should look not only to your own interests, but also to the interests of others. Your attitude should be the same as that of Christ Jesus...[who] made himself nothing, taking the very nature of a servant" Phil 2:3-5,7

4. I WILL SUPPORT THE TESTIMONY OF MY CHURCH

- a) By attending faithfully: "Let us not give up meeting together, as some are in the habit of doing, but let us encourage one another—and all the more as you see the Day approaching." Heb 10:25
- b) By living a godly life: "Whatever happens, conduct yourselves in a manner worthy of the gospel of Christ." Phil 1:27a. "As obedient children do not conform to the evil desires you had when you lived in ignorance. But just as He who called you is holy, so be holy in all you do" 1 Peter 1:14-16.
- c) By giving regularly: "A tithe of everything from the land, whether grain from the soil or fruit from the trees, belongs to the LORD; it is holy to the LORD." Lev 27:30 "On the first day of every week, each one of you should set aside a sum of money in keeping with his income, saving it up, so that when I come no collections will have to be made." 1 Cor 16:2

SECTION 5: Voting Rights of Membership

Every Member shall have the right to vote on the following matters: (a) annual budget of the Church, (b) election of the Church Executive, (c) disposition of all or substantially all the Church's assets, merger, or dissolution of the Church, (d) acquisition of real property and related indebtedness, (e) amendments to the Bylaws of the Church, (f) call or removal of the Senior/Lead Pastor.

SECTION 6: Termination of Membership

Members shall be removed from the Church rolls for any of the following reasons:

- a) Death, transfer of membership to another church by letter of recommendation which shall be granted after approval by the Church Executive lead by the lead Pastor, by personal request of the member.
- b) Dismissal according to the following conditions: When the member's conduct, public or private, violates the Membership Covenant as determined by the Church Executive, and such dismissal has been communicated to the Church in a timely manner by a Pastor, in accordance with Matthew 18:15-17.

SECTION 7: Restoration of Members

Members dismissed by the Church Executive shall be restored to full membership privileges by the Church Executive according to the spirit of 2 Corinthians 2:7,8 when their conduct is judged by the Pastors to be in accordance with the Membership Covenant. Pastors will communicate such restoration to the Church in a timely manner.

ARTICLE VII

Membership Meetings

SECTION 1: Place of Meeting

Meetings of the Members shall be held at such places or places within the Tulsa Metropolitan Area as may be designated from time to time by the Church Executive.

SECTION 2: Quorum of Membership meeting

Those Members present at a meeting called pursuant to ARTICLE VII, SECTION 4, shall constitute a quorum of the membership for the transaction of business. All items of business will be conducted using **simple majority** rule except where otherwise specified in these Bylaws.

SECTION 3: Assemblies/Meetings

The PBC Assembly is the highest authority in the overall function of the church. There shall be no project run without the permission of the assembly. There shall be three types of assembly (membership) meetings, the general assembly, annual assembly, special/emergency assembly meeting.

SECTION 3 (A) General Assembly

The PBC general assembly shall be held every three years (i.e. at the end of a three-year term for elected church leaders). The PBC general assembly member includes all the Baptized (18 years and above) member of the church. The purpose of this general assembly shall be to conduct an election of the Church Executive and department leaders for the next term, and to adopt an annual budget. Any other proper business may be conducted at this meeting, when approved by the Senior/Lead Pastor or majority of the Church Executive, but only if the notice requirements of ARTICLE VII, SECTION 4 have been complied regarding the said item(s) of business. The meeting quorum should be at least **two-thirds of its members**. Other than that, shall be called annual/general meetings for the church as shown in ARTICLE VII, SECTION 2 (B).

SECTION 3 (B) Election of the church (See Church Policy Section 6)

All elected posts shall have a three-year term, and there shall be an election for every elected post at the end of the term unless there are new positions created, or any position stays vacant due to any reason. The election procedures are as follows.

- 1) The Moderator shall serve as a presiding officer.
- 2) The Recording Secretary shall be a returning officer.
- 3) Any candidate shall have a proposal and seconded.
- 4) The church executive will have a list of proposed executive members for the new term but should not exceed more than 50% of the existing members.
- 5) All elections shall be conducted with a secret ballot.
- 6) Eligible candidates will be members who are present and who are on leave granted by the assembly.

SECTION 3 (B) Annual/general Meetings

A general meeting of the Members shall be held on the Second Sunday of the year at such time as determined by the *Church Executive* (Church Executive). This general meeting shall be the annual membership meeting. The purpose of this meeting shall be to adopt an annual budget and to elect departmental leaders for any position that remains vacant due to resignation or

termination/removed. Any other proper business may be conducted at this meeting, when approved by the Senior/Lead Pastor or majority of the *Church Executive* Church Executive, but only if the notice requirements of ARTICLE VII, SECTION 4 have been complied with in regard to the said item(s) of business.

SECTION 3 (C) Half-Yearly Meetings

Half Yearly meeting of the Members shall be held on the First Sunday of July at such time as determined by the Church Executive. This general meeting shall be the half-yearly membership meeting. The purpose of this meeting shall be to evaluate and retrospect the functions of the church with respect to the resolutions adopted in the annual assembly. Any other proper business may be conducted at this meeting, when approved by the Senior/Lead Pastor or majority of the Church Executive, but only if the notice requirements of ARTICLE VII, SECTION 4 have been complied with in regard to the said item(s) of business.

SECTION 3 (D) Church Executive Meeting

The Church Executive meeting shall be held monthly, and the date of the meeting shall be put up on the church event calendar.

SECTION 3 (E) Staff Meeting

PBC staff includes the Church Executive, Core Committee, Departmental committee, and all other members who hold portfolios in the church. There shall be two important meetings in a year, one in the first half yearly, and another in the second half yearly, which will be marked in the church event calendar. Other than that, the Church Executive has the power/authority to call for staff emergency meetings as and when necessary.

SECTION 3 (F) Meeting Chair/Chairman

It shall be categorized as follows:

- 1) Executive Body Meetings: By default, the Lead Pastor shall serve as the Meeting chair/chairman for all Church Executive Body meetings, staff meetings, and emergency meetings. In the absence of the Lead Pastor, the Assistant Pastor shall assume this responsibility.
- 2) General Body Meetings: For all General Body meetings, including annual, half-yearly, and emergency meetings, the members shall elect a meeting chairman at the beginning of the meeting. The elected chairman shall preside over the General Assembly, elections, annual assembly, general meetings. Accordingly, the chairman should possess adequate experience in conducting and presiding over such meetings. He/she shall be the deciding factor in the event of a tie vote. His power and functions shall be limited to the duration of the meeting and shall conclude upon adjournment.

SECTION 4: Recording Secretaries

- a. In all the general body meetings, the Recording secretary shall be appointed by a majority vote of the members present. The recording secretary can be a male or female member of the church who has experience in the role and possesses the ability to accurately record

the minutes of the meeting. The recording secretary has the full right to express his/her opinion in the meeting. He/she shall vote in any election. He/she is responsible for recording the minutes of the meeting. Before the end of the meeting, the recording secretary shall read out all the resolutions that have been taken. Upon approval, all concerned signatories shall sign the resolution and hand it over to the pastor for further action.

- b. In all the Executive, staff, and emergency meetings, the Assistant pastor will serve as the recording secretary, as specified in *Art. VIII, sec. 3-a*.

SECTION 5: Special Meetings

Special meetings may be called at any time and for any purpose by a majority of the Church Executive or by the Lead Pastor, by giving notice to the Members in accordance with ARTICLE VII, SECTION 4.

1) Notice Requirements for Membership Meetings

General Requirements. Whenever Members are required or permitted to take any action at a meeting, notice shall be given to Members no less than ten (10) days or more than sixty (60) days prior to a meeting. Notification of membership meetings shall be given in any of the following manners, any of which shall be deemed to be a reasonable method of calling a membership meeting:

- a) Distribution of written material to the congregation in attendance at a regular weekend service.
- b) Oral announcement to the congregation at a regularly scheduled service.
- c) By United States mail to each Member identified on the membership roll using their last known address per the membership roll.

Notice of Certain Agenda Items. Action by the Members on any of the following proposals is valid only if the notice specifies the general nature of the proposal:

- a) Disposition of all or substantially all the Church's assets,
- b) Merger or dissolution of the Church,
- c) Acquisition of real property and related indebtedness,
- d) Amendments to the Certificate of Incorporation or Bylaws of the Church,
- e) Call or removal of the Lead Pastor.

ARTICLE VIII

PASTORS

Pastors here refer to every ordained pastor who has full membership in the church, is eligible to perform any legal procedure of the church in general, and includes lead pastors, assistant pastors, and departmental pastors, in particular.

SECTION 1: Licentiate Candidacy, Requirements, and Pastor Ordination Procedures

SECTION 1(A): Licentiate Candidacy, Requirements

Anyone committed to serve in full time ministry and desiring to apply for Licentiate candidacy must have the following:

- 1) He must be born again and have a commendable testimony within and outside the church.
- 2) He must be spiritually mature (He should not be a new believer).
- 3) He must be fully committed to the church ministry and actively involves in whatever ways he can.
- 4) He must have a strong and right standing on the Biblical doctrines.
- 5) He must be a theological graduate from a reputed theological college/have any diploma in ministry and/or theological college.
- 6) He must be someone committed and ready to enter full time ministry in the church or someone the church has decided to employ as pastor. He can also be someone committed to go for missionary within and outside the country.
- 7) He must be a member of the church for a minimum of two years.

SECTION 1(B) Procedures for Licentiate Confirmation & Ordination.

- 1) The candidate must submit a written application to the Lead Pastor copy to other members of the Core Committee along with necessary documents.
- 2) The Core Committee shall do a comprehensive background study of the candidate (s) and gather all required supporting documents. After having careful deliberation on the matter and a consensus agreement of the Core Committee to proceed with the ordination process, the matter shall be put forward to the Church Executive for further action.
- 3) The Church Executive, on receiving recommendations from the Core Committee shall forward the matter to the assembly for final approval. The assembly shall vote on the matter, if 2/3 of the members voted in favor of the candidate, the assembly must propose a date to confer Licentiate Pastor for the candidate.
- 4) From the date of conferring licentiate pastor, the lead pastor shall be responsible in supervising and training the candidate for practical ministry for a minimum of one year Probation.
- 5) After a year of probation, the lead pastor shall give a report and recommendation of the candidate to the Church Executive. Based on the recommendation of the lead pastor, the Church Executive shall decide the (Date & time) for ordination of the candidate.
- 6) The ordination shall be officiated by the lead/assistant pastor of the local church in the presence of the congregational members.

SECTION 1(C): Pastor/Reverend Ordination:

Ordination is the official recognition of the local church that God has called and gifted a man for service in that church, accompanied by their commission to advance the cause of Christ. It is the responsibility of each local church to recognize the man or men God has called to serve Him in that place, to set them apart for ministry, to safeguard the ministry, and to provide an occasion that will encourage them in years to come. Therefore, someone who seek to get Pastor ordination shall have the following qualifications.

- 1) He must be born again and have a commendable testimony within and outside the church.
- 2) He must be spiritually mature (He should not be a new believer).
- 3) He must be fully committed to the church ministry and actively involves in whatever ways he can.
- 4) He must have a strong and right standing on the Biblical doctrines.
- 5) He must be a theological graduate with a document proof from a reputed theological college/have any diploma in ministry and/or theological college.
- 6) He must have a document to prove that he has been in ministry with a minimum of three years in the field of Christian/church ministries.
- 7) He must be someone committed and ready to enter full time ministry in the church or someone the church has decided to employ as pastor. He can also be someone committed to go for missionary within and outside the country.
- 8) He must obtain a recommendation (NOC) from his mother church.
- 9) He must be a member of the church for a minimum of two years.

SECTION 1(D): Procedures for Pastor/Reverend Ordination.

- 1) The candidate must submit a written application to the Lead Pastor copy to other members of the Core Committee along with necessary documents.
- 2) The Core Committee shall do a comprehensive background study of the candidate (s) and gather all required supporting documents. After having careful deliberation on the matter and a consensus agreement of the Core Committee to proceed with the ordination process, the matter shall be put forward to the Church Executive for further action.
- 3) The Church Executive, on receiving recommendations from the Core Committee shall forward the matter to the assembly for final approval. The assembly shall vote on the matter, if 2/3 of the members vote in favor of the candidate, the assembly must propose a date for the ordination of the candidate.
- 4) The ordination shall be officiated by the lead/assistant pastor of the local church in the presence of the congregational members.

SECTION 2: The Lead Pastor

The Lead pastor is the first in line of the leadership in the church and the head shepherd of the church. The lead pastor shall always be alert and vigilant in overseeing the movement of the church members, and the overall function of the church. Thus, the church agreed to set some important roles, responsibilities, and authority of the lead pastor in the church for well and systematic functioning of the church.

SECTION 2 (A): Qualification of the Lead Pastor

The lead Pastor shall have the following qualifications/requirements:

- 1) He must be truly born again and have burden for the lost.
- 2) He must be spiritually mature, mission minded, visionary leader, and good at team building.
- 3) He must be called by God, have a clear commitment to lead the flocks as required by the word of God no matter what.
- 4) He must be a person with integrity, not given to wine, love the church of God.
- 5) He must be willing to serve the church of God out of love and respect, not as an employee.
- 6) He must be willing to submit himself to the leadership of the church.
- 7) He must be a pastor/reverend ordain and have a minimum of five years experienced in pastoral ministry.
- 8) He must be creative, emotionally stable, and able to relate constructively to other people.

SECTION 2 (B) Authority of the Lead Pastor

The Lead Pastor shall have the general oversight of the operations of the Church and shall have the authority to take all actions that are necessary and proper to exercise his oversight responsibilities within the Certificate of Incorporation and within these Bylaws. Among other things, the Lead Pastor shall have the authority to appoint and remove all agents and employees of the Church and prescribe any powers and duties for them that are consistent with law, with the Certificate of Incorporation, and with these Bylaws. Any appointee shall be brought before the Church Executive for further questions (if necessary) and approval.

SECTION 2 (C): Responsibilities of the Lead Pastor

- 1) The lead pastor is defined as the head of the administrative body, commonly called the church elders (Church Executive). With the help of the elders (Church Executive), the pastor oversees the overall functions of the church. The utmost responsibility of the Lead Pastor in the church/upon his Church members is to provide appropriate spiritual teaching and nurture in their spiritual growth, (i.e., the pastor is responsible for delivering gospel message at least two Sunday a month).
- 2) The lead pastor acts as a manager of sorts to the paid/unpaid church staff, which often includes a secretary, office manager and custodian.

- 3) The lead pastor along with the Church Executive ensure that the church is adhering to the laws set by the Southern Baptist Churches and the Bible. This includes dealing with conflicts within the church and any discipline issues that may arise.
- 4) The lead pastor shall be responsible in performing weddings ceremony, Child dedication, baptism of new believer(s), counseling, funeral, and conducting holy communion. In case of his inability to perform, he can assign other Pastors within the church to perform on his behalf.
- 5) The lead Pastor must visit homes and visit infirm members of the congregation at homes, in the hospital or nursing homes.
- 6) The lead Pastor shall arrange program well ahead when there is the need for dedicating new assets in the church (for members, it shall only be arranged on the request of the member).
- 7) As the head of the church, the lead pastor is expected to serve as an ambassador or liaison between the church and the community.
- 8) The lead shall seek advice from the advisory board as and when necessary or willing to listen advice from the advisory board.
- 9) The lead pastor is responsible for signing contract with any parties whether it be from government or private entities.
- 10) The Lead Pastor shall act as a copyright holder for anything that bear the name Peniel Baptist Church, the PBC website and its content, all social media platforms, any printed and unprinted documents belonging to the church, etc.

SECTION 2 (D): Call or Removal of the Senior Pastor

The Lead Pastor may be called or removed only by a vote of at least 2/3 votes of the Members in attendance at a Membership meeting called for that purpose pursuant to ARTICLE VII, SECTION 4 of this Bylaws.

SECTION 3: Assistant Pastor

Assistant Pastor is the second in line of the leadership of the church. Assistant pastor can be one or more based of the church structural set up. The assistant pastor(s) is responsible for assisting the lead Pastor of the Church as needed for the smooth functioning of the church. Other than assisting the lead pastor, the assistant pastor also has a specific role and responsibilities in the church (see Section article VIII, Section 4 (B))

SECTION 3 (A): Qualification of Assistant Pastor

- 1) He must be a born-again Christian fully committed to Christian service.
- 2) He must be an ordained Pastor (Reverend)
- 3) He must have work experience in the church.
- 4) He must be creative, emotionally stable, and able to relate constructively to other people.
- 5) He must have a theological degree from a reputed Seminary/accepted by the PBC.

SECTION 3 (B): Responsibilities of Assistant Pastor

- 1) The assistant pastor shall serve as secretary of the Church.

- 2) The Assistant pastor shall report to the lead/senior pastor in all matters of church administration. In the absence of a lead Pastor, the assistant pastor will be responsible to the interim team leader named during the time of transition.
- 3) Assistant pastor shall Collect and compile information for weekly Church bulletin and hand over to the media director for the final setting and putting up to the church app and other social platform of the church for information. In case of Media director inability/unavailability the assistant pastor (secretary of the church) can shall take the responsibility of doing the job.
- 4) Assistant pastor shall be responsible for arranging and announcing any important announcement.
- 5) Assistant pastor shall perform other duties as assigned by the lead pastor or the Church Executive.
- 6) Assistant Pastor can perform all church legal procedure in the absence of the lead pastor or if the lead pastor assigned him to the job.

ARTICLE IX WORKERS/EMPLOYEES

Worker(s)/employee(s) here refers to as those that are appointed and employed by the church as paid staff whether it be full time or part time. Each employee is responsible for the wellbeing of the church. Despite the differences in position and capacities, every employee must have one thing in common that is to serve the church of God in unity. For any paid worker/staff in the church, the church has laid down a few guidelines to follow with regards to the leave rule and working days.

SECTION 1: Leave Rule for paid staffer.

Any Full-time PBC worker/staffer shall have the following leave rules:

- a) Casual leave for 13 days a year and not more than four consecutive days at a time.
- b) Earned leave shall be 30 days a year, and another 30 days with half pay if the situation demands.
- c) Maternity and special leave shall be 60 days a year, and another 60 days with half pay if the situation demands.
- d) Leave rules for a part-time worker or staffer must be the same as full-time worker/staffer.

SECTION 2: Working Days.

- a) Any Full-time worker/staffer is required to engage in ministry of the church for a minimum of 40 hours of 5 days schedules a week.
- b) Any part-time worker/staff is required to make 20 hours a week with flexible schedules.
- c) All PBC workers/staffers shall give a brief report of their activities in writing half-yearly to the assembly addressing the Moderator/lead pastor.

SECTION 3: Termination of Employee & Staff

- a) The job performance of any paid and unpaid staff/worker shall be evaluated at the end of every financial year.
- b) Based on the evaluation, any employee/pay worker staff member of the church is liable for explanation call, suspend, or termination of employment at any time by the church Core Committee/Church Executive.
- c) If anyone (paid/unpaid) is suspended from his/her position, his /her suspension shall not be revoked until he/she shows a genuine makeover of his/her mistake in the past.
- d) If anyone (paid/unpaid) is terminated from his/her position, he/she shall not be qualified to hold any position in the church until he/she shows a genuine makeover of his/her mistake in the past.

ARTICLE X COMMITTEE OF THE CHURCH

The committee of the church includes, core committee, Church Executive, Core Committee, and all other departmental committees elected by the PBC general assembly for one three-year term in its general business session.

SECTION 1: CORE COMMITTEE

SECTION 1(A): Establishment and Makeup of the Core Committee

The Core/Core Committee is a group of people selected by the church to look into any and every important project and plans of the church. The committee is comprised of all the ordained pastors with full membership of the church.

SECTION 1 (B): Responsibilities of the Core Committee

- 1) Initiates planning (Houbung khantou-machal nading'a bidoi semtohd ding)
- 2) Establishes goals (Bidoi lhunthei nadinga kichehtah a tup le doi semtohd ding)
- 3) Implements action plans (Bidoiho tongdoh ding le molso sah ding)
- 4) Evaluates effectiveness for congregational ministries of nurture, outreach, witness, and administration (Houbung mipiho lhagao ann a vahkhang ding, Houbung pamlam'a sakhi a ipan nahou vetup ding le vekol ding, Houbung khantou-machal nading'a dan le mol vetup jing ding le Houbung sung kivaihomna semtohd ding).
- 5) The core committee shall act as an advisory board for the lead pastor.
- 6) The Core Committee shall closely monitor the effectiveness of every staff (paid and unpaid) and conduct secret/open evaluation for any/every staff (paid/unpaid) member as and when necessary, apart from the evaluation set for the end of every financial year (ART. IX SEC. 2).
- 7) The Core Committee shall serve as Pastor search committee and ordination committee.
- 8) The committee shall be responsible for observing the pastoral ministry of the church carefully and when found necessary to invite application for ordination shall bring the matter to the attention of the Church Executive for further consideration.
- 9) In the case of any individual applicant, the committee shall bring the matter to the attention of the Church Executive for further consideration. If the Church Executive agrees to proceed in both the cases, they shall return the matter to the Core Committee.
- 10) The core committee shall conduct further examination of the applicants' testimony and background.
- 11) Conduct interviews for the applicant, applicant's family & friends.

- 12) Gather all necessary documents of the applicant including recommendation from every possible referral such as mother (home) church, Pastor, past employers, etc.
- 13) Upon the completion of all necessary procedures, if the Core Committee agrees to move ahead with the ordination process, it shall forward the case to the Church Executive for final approval in the assembly.

SECTION 2: CHURCH EXECUTIVE

SECTION 2 (A): Establishment and Composition of the Church Executive

There shall be a Church Executive, which shall be comprised of the lead Pastor, assistant pastor, Mission chairman, women chairperson, Youth chairman, Finance Secretary, and Christian education Minister of the Church with a minimum of Seven (7) members and a maximum of eleven (11) members. The following are a few guidelines for the formation of the Church Executive.

- a) The existing/current church executive shall have the authority to recommend candidates for the next term, but it should not have more than 50% of the existing members. This proposal shall be approved by the assembly unless the floor has proposed a different candidate for the post.
- b) Lead Pastor in his sole discretion can propose a replacement if any of the church executive is relieved from the job, which shall be later approved by the assembly.
- c) The lead Pastor has the sole authority and discretion to remove any member for any cause deemed insufficient by the lead Pastor, which shall be latter approve by the assembly.

The Church Executive may include Lead Pastor (chairman), Assistant Pastor (Secretary), Mission chairman, Christian Education Minister, Finance Secretary, Men Chairman, Women Chairperson, Youth Pastor/chairman, Media director, and Worship & Music minister.

SECTION 2 (B): Responsibilities of the Church Executive

- 1) The Church Executive is responsible for the smooth functioning of the church and its growth.
- 2) They shall take responsibility to execute the resolution of the annual assembly.
- 3) They shall also oversee the church body and organize outreach services for individuals or families in need. Unless the matter requires the consent of the church body (general body), the Church Executive has the authority to make decisions on their own in any matter related to the growth and development of the church.
- 4) They shall take responsibility to carry out the church projects and they have the authority to organize fund raising programs of any kind to achieve the church project as planned.
- 5) The Church Executive shall have special meetings on the third Sunday of every month as planned in the Event Calendar. In case of emergency, the lead Pastor shall call an emergency meeting for the committee.
- 6) Any Team member should respect the scheduled meetings and other emergency meetings of the Church Executive. Member who in any case could not make it to the meeting must give a prior notice to the lead Pastor with a good reason.
- 7) Committee members who are consecutively absent for three meetings without asking for leave should be considered seriously and such a member can be liable to be replaced from his/her position in the church.

SECTION 3: Departmental Leaders

The Ministry departments such as Mission, Christian Education, Women, and Youth departments will be formed to strengthen the Pastoral Care and outreach ministry of the Church. The elected leader (Chairman/chairperson) of the various departments will be representative members of the Church Executive. The department leaders shall be elected by the church members in the general meeting, Except for women chairperson, and they shall be men and women who are members of the Church and meet the qualifications as set forth in 1 Timothy 3:8-13.

SECTION 3 (A): Mission Department.

Mission being the heart and soul of the church should be considered vital in the ministry of the church. The church ministry should give utmost important to the Great Commission of the Lord Jesus Christ (Matt. 28:16-20). The department shall have a committee led by the Mission chairman to oversee the mission work of the church. The Committee members shall be a minimum of three and maximum of seven members elected by the general election/assembly of the church for a three-year term.

SECTION 3 (A) (i): Committee Member.

- Chairman :
- Secretary :
- Member (3) :

SECTION 3 (A) (ii): Responsibilities of Mission Committee.

- 1) The Mission Committee shall oversee PBC's mission strategy, making sure it aligns and supports the church's mission and core values, to actively engage in mission activities.
- 2) The mission committee shall focus on both reached and unreached people groups as well as local, regional, and international partnerships.
- 3) Mission Committee shall assist in the development and administration of the annual mission's budget, and be responsible for mission fundraising and the collection of Missionary boxes each month.
- 4) Mission committee shall participate in church sponsored mission trips and encourage other members to participate and assist in organizing projects and programs.
- 5) The Mission Committee shall meet at least four times a year to discuss important matters related to mission and evangelism works.

SECTION 3 (A) (iii): Responsibilities of Mission Chairman.

- a) The minister shall serve as the chairman of the mission department and work closely with the committee and oversee the execution of the goals and plans of the mission committee.
- b) The mission minister shall engage with the PBC's mission team to evaluate past, present, and future mission opportunities.
- c) The mission minister shall facilitate mission projects and short-term mission trips. Challenge, motivate and recruit church members for involvement in missions.
- d) The mission minister shall call a meeting as and when necessary.

- e) The mission minister shall introduce new ideas and ministries that will stimulate the mission vision of the church.

SECTION 3(A) (iv): Qualifications Mission Chairman.

- a) The mission minister should be a committed and mission minded member within the church.
- b) The Mission Minister shall have a minimum of five years of church or on-the-field missions experience.
- c) The Mission Minister shall have the ability to plan, organize, direct, and oversee mission's ministry.
- d) The Mission Minister shall demonstrate the ability to cultivate relationships and rally others around the ministry's vision and goals.

SECTION 3(A) (v): PBC Mission Project.

PBC is committed to spreading the gospel of Jesus Christ in whatever ways we can. "Reach and teach with Jesus' Compassion" being the theme, PBC will always give Mission work as the focus of the church's ministry. The mission department committee members shall pray and plan for fresh missions and outreach projects as and when necessary, such projects shall be forwarded to the church executive for further action. Thus, PBC shall be involved in sponsoring missionaries based on its missionary manual/policy through the mission department.

SECTION 3 (B): Men Department.

PBC men department is formed by married men within the church with a special focus in having a closer relationship within the men and works together for the furtherance of the gospel of Christ. They shall function under the guidance of the church executive. The department shall have a committee with a minimum of three members and they are called the leader of the department. The men department shall elect the committee (not the chairman) for one three-year term along with the minutes of their annual meeting and forward to the church executive for assembly approval. The department shall have a plan, project and annual budget that shall be approved by the assembly. Any property owned by the department shall be made available in the church office, and any amount of cash they have shall be deposited in the PBC men's bank account.

SECTION 3 (B) (i): Men Department Committee.

The department Committee shall consist of the following portfolios.

- Chairperson :
- Secretary :
- Member (1) :

SECTION 3 (B) (ii): Responsibilities of the Men Committee.

- a) The men Department Committee are a group of leaders elected/approved by the PBC general assembly for three years term.
- b) They shall oversee the overall function of the department in every aspect.

- c) They shall oversee the development and coordination of ministry to all the men in the church and work hard for the welfare and spiritual development of the department.
- d) Prepare for and lead weekly/monthly/quarterly meetings including Executive Committee meetings.
- e) They shall take responsibilities for the men fellowship and /weekly/monthly/quarterly prayer meeting as and when/where necessary.
- f) They shall work under the supervision of the PBC Church Executive.
- g) They shall execute responsibilities entrusted to them by the department and the PBC assembly as planned.
- h) They will schedule any special event for the department and fulfill any type of project approved by the PBC assembly.
- i) They shall develop plans, projects and the annual proposed budget for the department and put forward to the Church Executive for assembly approval.
- j) They shall be responsible for overseeing the distribution of funds and keeping track of expenditure.
- k) They shall make fund raising for the department as and when necessary, with the approval of the Church Executive.
- l) Participate in and oversee special events and activities for men.
- m) Administer the work of men's ministries by encouraging teamwork and mutual support and by providing leadership for all.
- n) Pray regularly for the men of the church for God's direction.
- o) Cast ministry vision, establish goals by prioritizing related programs.
- p) Oversee the need of the church members like help with yard cleaning, house painting, moving homes, etc. and make necessary arrangement.
- q) Attend monthly Leadership Ministry meetings with the pastor and other church leaders.
- r) Be accountable to the men department, the Church Executive, and church members.

SECTION 3 (C): Women Department.

PBC Woman department is formed by the married women within the Church with a special focus on having prayer fellowship, women's worship, and other church ministries when and where their involvement is in demand by the church under the guidance and direction of the PBC Church Executive. The department shall have a committee with a minimum of three members and those committee shall function as the department leader for a three-year term. The department shall elect the committee for one term and forwarded to the Church Executive with the minutes of the annual/general women's meeting for assembly approval. The department shall arrange any activity as and when necessary. The department shall have the annual budget approved by the PBC annual assembly. Any property owned by the department shall be made available in the church office, and any amount of cash they have shall be deposited in the PBC bank account.

SECTION 3 (C) (i): Women Department Committee.

The department Committee shall consist of the following portfolios.

- Chairperson :
- Secretary :
- Member (1) :

SECTION 3 (C) (ii): Responsibilities of the Women Committee.

- a) The women Department Committee are a group of leaders elected/approved by the PBC general assembly for one three years term.
- b) They shall oversee the overall function of the department in every aspect.
- c) They shall oversee the development and coordination of ministry to all the women in the church and work hard for the welfare and spiritual development of the department.
- d) Prepare for and lead monthly meetings including Executive Committee meetings.
- e) They shall take responsibility for the women fellowship and monthly/weekly prayer meeting as and when/where necessary.
- f) They shall work under the supervision of the PBC Church Executive.
- g) They shall execute responsibilities entrusted to them by the department and the PBC assembly as planned.
- h) They will schedule any special event for the department and fulfill any type of project approved by the PBC assembly.
- i) They shall develop plans, projects and the annual proposed budget for the department and put forward to the Church Executive for assembly approval.
- j) They shall be responsible for overseeing the distribution of funds and keep track of expenditure.
- k) They shall make fund raising for the department as and when necessary, with the approval of the Church Executive.
- l) Participate in and oversee special events and activities for women.
- m) Administer the work of women's ministries by encouraging teamwork and mutual support and by providing leadership for all.
- n) Pray regularly for the women of the church and God's direction.
- o) Cast ministry vision, establish goals by prioritizing related programs.
- p) Oversee the planning and coordinating of special interest classes such as: cooking, gardening, needlework, crafts, etc.
- q) Attend monthly Leadership Ministry Meetings with the pastor and other church leaders.
- r) Be accountable to the women department, the Church Executive, and church members.

SECTION 3 (D): Youth Department.

Youth are the future leaders of the church. According to the research result of Barna Group 59% (percent) of the teens stop involved in the church after age 15, either temporarily or permanently. Teens need a place to congregate and want opportunities to do things with friends; parents want their children involved with activities under the watchful eye of an adult

they trust. Therefore, the best way to keep teenagers get involved in the church activities is to set up a very active, vibrant youth department lead by a committed, spiritually strong, and mature youth leader (pastor). The department shall function within the guidelines/bylaws of the PBC under the supervision of the Church Executive. The department shall have a committee to lead the department in all aspects of its function. The youth committee/leader/pastor may organize the youth group and schedule Bible studies, youth group parties, outings such as ski trips and mission trips as and when necessary for different age group. The department shall have the annual budget for the department approved by the PBC annual assembly. Any property owned by the department shall be made available in the church office, and any amount of cash they have shall be deposited in the PBC bank account.

SECTION 3 (D) (i): Youth Department Committee.

The department Committee shall consist of the following portfolios.

- Chairman/pastor :
- Secretary :
- Finance :

SECTION 3 (D) (ii): Responsibilities of a youth committee.

- a) The Youth Department Committee is a group of leaders elected by the PBC general assembly for a three-year term.
- b) They shall oversee the overall function of the department and put their focus on the welfare and spiritual development of the Youth group.
- c) They will be responsibilities to arrange monthly/weekly youth group fellowship and prayer meeting as and when/where necessary.
- d) They shall work under the supervision of the PBC Church Executive.
- e) They shall execute all plans and projects for the department approved by the PBC assembly.
- f) They shall schedule any special event for the department within the department budget and project.
- g) They shall propose the annual budget for the department and projects to the Church Executive for necessary approval of the annual assembly.
- h) They shall make fund raising for the department as and when necessary, with the approval of the Church Executive.

SECTION 3 (D) (iii): Qualification of a Youth Chairman/Pastor.

- a) Youth chairman/pastor must be a born again, theologically graduate in Baptist recognized seminary.
- b) Youth Chairman/Pastor must have solid knowledge of the Bible and their church's teachings.

- c) Youth Chairman/pastor must have to walk the walk as well as talk the talk; if the church teaches premarital sex is wrong, for example, a Youth Chairman/Pastor who is living with his girlfriend will send the wrong message.

SECTION 3 (D) (iv): Responsibilities of a Youth Chairman/Pastor.

- A) Youth Chairman/pastor should act as a confidant.
- B) Youth Charman/pastor shall be a source of counseling for those who are in spiritual dilemma looking for answers on how Christian beliefs and practices fits into their lives.
- c) Youth chairman/pastor shall work with the ministerial staff, appropriate committees, and program leaders in planning, evaluating, and coordinating all youth ministries of the church.
- D) YOUTH CHAIRMAN/PASTOR shall act as a loving counselor and adviser, also at times simply offer a listening ear to those whom he led.
- E) YOUTH CHAIRMAN/PASTOR must always maintain confidences and give advice in a way that doesn't alienate teens. However, a Youth Chairman/Pastor must also set appropriate boundaries and follow proper procedures to avoid any misinterpretation of his actions.
- F) YOUTH CHAIRMAN/PASTOR shall undergo training for effective ministries.
- g) Conduct special training projects for youth workers.
- h) Advise in the use of program materials, equipment, supplies and space by youth groups in all church program organizations.
- i) Administer and plan numerous youth programs like evangelism, retreats, and Bible study sessions.
- j) Coordinate with parents of youth group members regarding their children's involvement and participation in the church.
- k) Plan and direct youth groups in all church programs, fellowships, retreats, and other important events for the department.
- l) Lead in a weekly youth visitation program.
- m) Remain informed of current trends in youth education programs and youth culture.
- n) Be alerted to win the lost and assist both workers and youth in reaching the unreached.
- o) Youth Chairman/Pastor also provide feedback and input to senior pastors.
- p) Train youths on how to be future faith-filled leaders and set up programs to facilitate spiritual growth.
- q) Develop and maintain effective relationships with various leaders in the community for purposes of swift outreach programs.

SECTION 3 (E): Christian Education Department

The Christian Education department focuses on educating the members of the church to provide them with moral guidance. Through Christian education, people are taught the importance of life skills such as loving others, forgiving others, and being content. Christian education helps people learn more about the foundation of Christian beliefs and practices as outlined in the Bible.

Through Christian education, the church needs to educate its members to be more effective witnesses to the world (Matt. 28:18-20).

SECTION 3 (E-1) (i): Christian Education Minister (CEM).

The Christian Education Minister is responsible to the pastor for the total educational church program in planning, conducting, and evaluating a comprehensive Christian education ministry to achieve the mission of the church.

SECTION 3 (E) (ii): Qualification of CEM.

- a) CEM must be born again, committed, and experiencing God's call for ministry.
- b) CEM must have a minimum qualification of BA/its equivalent.
- c) CEM must be a theological graduate from a reputed seminary/institution.
- d) CEM shall be able and willing to teach in all areas of Christian (Baptist) doctrine, faith, and beliefs.
- e) CEM must be able to defend the Evangelical Baptist faith and practices from all sorts of cults and false teachers.

SECTION 3 (E) (iii): Responsibilities of CEM.

- a) Correlate all programs, plans and activities with the staff and church council.
- b) Always maintain the church calendar of activities.
- c) Train and work closely with the Nominating Committee in selecting and enlisting qualified leaders for the educational program.
- d) Responsible in organizing weekly Bible study and some other informal Bible studies during the week.
- e) The CEM might act as the administrator for the Sunday school program and might also run activities such as summer vacation Bible school.
- f) Serve as resource and liaison person for committees related to the educational program.
- g) Have a special plan and emphasis in educational programs (i.e. attendance campaigns, leadership recognition, Preparation Week, VBS, promotion, January Bible Study, etc.).
- h) Develop special educational/training projects such as camps, retreats, and seminars.
- i) Lead in any meeting related to a regular education program and organization planning.
- j) Lead in selecting and ensuring the most suitable educational materials and curriculum available.
- k) The CEM shall have the full authority to select/arrange CSS teachers as and when necessary and get acknowledgement from the church executive.

SECTION 3 (E) (iv): Responsibilities of Sunday School Teacher:

- a) Create lesson plans in line with the age and spiritual maturity of the kids in the church.
- b) Arrive early for class and ensure that all the kids are at the designated places on time.

- c) Prepare and oversee weekly Bible lessons.
- d) Help with all the fundraising events related to the Sunday school department.
- e) Develop educational plays and skits.
- f) Attend weekly meetings with all assigned teachers and management staff.
- g) Respond to all Sunday-school related issues and offer guidance.
- h) Ensure that the designated area of the Sunday school is clean and presentable.
- i) Be exemplary and a role model for Sunday school children.
- j) Oversee the attendance record.
- k) Have a good relationship and an open communication with the church education minister.

SECTION 3 (F): Finance Team

The Church shall have a Finance Secretary, an Assistant Finance Secretary, and auditors to maintain accurate financial records. The church shall have three auditors, two audits in a year, one in the first week of July, and another (annual audit) in the first week of January.

SECTION 3 (F) (i) Role & Responsibilities of Finance Secretary

- a) Finance Secretary shall be elected/appointed by the general assembly.
- b) Work according to the policies and procedures established by the church.
- c) Receive, record and receipt funds from all sources and report them to the Church Executive, or Auditors.
- d) Receive offerings collected during worship services and count them at the conclusion of the services, ensuring more than one person is involved collecting and counting the offerings.
- e) Ensure funds are deposited in a bank as soon as they are received. Deposits should be made within three days of receipt.
- f) Post receipts and disbursements of all accounts according to the financial system.
- g) Post the weekly offerings to individual accounts.
- h) Reconcile the bank statement monthly.
- i) Always maintain debit voucher and Actual payee receipt for expenditure with no original receipt/Cash memo.
- j) The Finance Secretary should always remember that any expenditure without debit voucher support is never in any case acceptable.
- k) Prepare monthly and annual financial reports for the Church Executive, and church business meetings.
- l) Establish a procedure to collect and record funds received other than through regular offerings, including funds received in the mail or electronically.
- m) Report regularly to the Church Executive regarding total funds pledged and received for the year.
- n) Report to the congregation at Annual Meeting regarding total funds pledged (if appropriate) and received for the year.
- o) Inform and encourage regular, systematic giving by congregations through providing information regarding electronic giving.
- p) Maintain confidentiality of all financial information pertaining to receiving, recording, and depositing of funds.

- q) Maintain a file of invoices, correspondence, and reports.
- r) Prepare and issue checks to staff members, designations, and organizations in accordance with approved church policy.
- s) Orders/purchases church and office supplies when necessary.
- t) Take responsibility in maintenance of necessities for the church.
- u) Finance Secretary must prepare a week earlier for audit and submit all related files to the lead pastor for verification and countersign on the voucher. Without which, the auditors should not do the audit.

SECTION 3 (F) (ii) Role & Responsibilities of Assistant Finance Secretary

- a) Assistant finance shall be elected/appointed by the general assembly.
- b) The main responsibility of the assistant finance is to assist the finance secretary in all financial matters.
- c) In the absence of the finance secretary, the Assistant finance shall automatically take the position of finance secretary as and when necessary.
- d) The assistant Finance secretary must be aware of the roles and responsibilities of the finance secretary and have constant communication with the finance secretary.

SECTION 3 (F) (iii) Responsibilities of Auditors:

- a) Perform routine audit functions within the congregation.
- b) Maintain audit files.
- c) Assign and train audit personnel in carrying out audits and assist in addressing issues as they surface.
- d) Respond expeditiously to the requests for emergency audits and assign personnel to assist or direct in these audits.
- e) Respond effectively to requests for information regarding church treasury functions, including denominational policies, IRS rules & regulations, and internal controls.
- f) Report the audit results and coverage periods at the half-yearly and year-end assembly.
- g) The auditors will have full access to every church financial account (Hard/soft) during the audit session.
- h) The auditors can propose training/seminar/system change if necessary and for the good of the church financial system/condition.
- i) Other duties as needed or assigned by the Church Executive.

SECTION 3 (G): Media & Sound

The Media & Sound department shall function under the leadership of the technical director supervised by the Church Executive. The media and sound team can be expanded as per the need of the department. They shall be responsible for handling and maintenance of anything related to Media & Sound outside and within the church premises.

SECTION 3 (G) (i) Responsibilities of Technical Director

- a) Operates, maintains, and safeguards the technical assets of the church, including supervising the use of lighting, sound, video and lighting systems, and communications equipment.
- b) Advises production managers, lighting, video and sound designers, on the technical specifications, costs and usage of technical equipment required for the ministries and supervises the implementation of approved technical designs.
- c) Supervises and assists with set and stage construction and management.
- d) Assists in recruiting, training and assignment of volunteer or paid technical staff.
- e) Assist in recording special events and video shoots.
- f) Assists with the preparation and control of production budgets; maintains inventory and orders specialized supplies.
- g) Attending technical rehearsals, in order to supervise and assist in the technical aspects of the services.
- h) Make recommendations to the church leadership regarding capital purchases of technical equipment.
- i) Designs, sets up, maintains, and operates lighting, video and sound systems for theatre, dance, music, and other productions and projects; assists guest designers and arts with technical matters.

SECTION 3 (G) (ii): Responsibilities of Media & Sound team

- a) The Media & Sound Team is directly linked to the Church Executive.
- b) The technical & media director shall supervise all the media and sound personnel on all occasions in the church.
- c) The Media & Sound Team should ensure that all the sound systems are up to date or working conditions all the time.
- d) Shall report it to the church staff for any issues related to media and sounds.
- e) For any new purchase, repair or replacement needed, the leader shall reach out to the Church Staff member or Church Executive.
- f) The Media & Sound Team should ensure that all the song Notes/Lyrics, Soundtracks, Power Points for the day are compiled in well advance and reviewed.
- g) In Charge shall do monthly maintenance check to all the instruments related to media and sounds and share report to the church staff.
- h) They can have a plan to purchase items within the limit of a budget or with the consent of the Church Executive.

ARTICLE XI

INDIVIDUAL PORTFOLIOS

SECTION 1: Property In-charge

Property In-charge shall be responsible for taking care of both movable and immovable properties of the church.

A. Responsibilities of Property In-charge

- 1) Property in charge shall be elected/appointed by the general assembly.

- 2) The main responsibility is listing all assets, moveable and immovable assets.
- 3) The property In-charge shall have full knowledge of PBC property.
- 4) The property In-charge shall maintain an updated record of the property list and be able to present to the auditors/Church Executive/public as and when necessary.
- 5) The property In-charge shall give an immediate report to the Church Executive/pastor in case of damage on any of the church property.
- 6) When obtaining new asset(s) the property In-charge shall contact the lead pastor for any assets that needs to be officially dedicated.

SECTION 2: Worship and Music Minister

The worship and music minister shall have the responsibility of leading the total music ministry of the church, as well as the praise and worship ministry. He/she will provide visionary and pastoral leadership over all music and worship ministry at Peniel Baptist Church, including music, production, training, and spiritual care of members within the church and its ministry.

SECTION 2(A): Responsibilities.

- 1) Proactively and effectively plan all musical, vocal, and technical facets of the worship service.
- 2) Oversee staff and volunteers who implement facets of the worship service.
- 3) Develop and implement vision for a cohesive worship philosophy across life stage ministries.
- 4) Oversee recruitment of team members and development of worship team and musicians for all areas of worship.
- 5) Oversee creation and use of media elements in the worship services and use of media for streaming, web training and recruitment purposes.
- 6) Plan and manage annual budget for worship and production.
- 7) Support special events of other church ministries with worship and production support.
- 8) Form and disciple the worship team and production team members in the maturing of their faith and gifting.
- 9) Must be responsible for all church related song services within and outside the church.
- 10) Teach, sing with and/or lead songs with choirs/ensembles as requested.
- 11) Independently manage praise team rehearsals.
- 12) Manage all administrative duties related to the praise team. (Schedules attire & etc.)
- 13) Manage Planning Center about praise and worship. (Scheduling, music uploads and, etc.)
- 14) Provide the AV team with song lyrics (formatted for singing) and any other visuals.
- 15) Build the praise team spiritually, numerically, and vocally. Develop quality leaders and singers.
- 16) Coordinate the music program with the organizational calendar and emphases of the church.

- 17) Monitor the purchasing, maintenance, and replacement of all music-related equipment, supplies and instruments.
- 18) Prepare an annual music budget for approval and administer the budget

SECTION 2 (B): Spiritual and Character Qualifications.

- 1) Clear testimony of faith in Jesus Christ and a passionate, growing personal relationship with Him
- 2) High moral integrity consistent with the Biblical qualifications for church leaders as outlined in Scripture (1 Timothy 3:1-7, Titus 1:5-9, 1 Peter 5:1-5)
- 3) Commitment to the doctrine, vision, and philosophy of the PBC.
- 4) Teachable spirit with a desire to be held accountable.
- 5) Team player with a positive attitude and a willingness to work collaboratively.
- 6) Ministry partner willing to voice concern and disagreement in a respectful manner while following accepted relationships of authority, responsibility, and leadership.

SECTION 3: Responsibilities of the Janitor in charge

A person who supervised all the cleaning operations in the church and responsible for maintaining a clean facility by scheduling church members in completing a variety of cleaning tasks. Below are some of the duties of Janitor In charge.

- a) Janitor in charge shall lead the church members in cleaning the interior of buildings, including floors, carpet, rugs, windows, all the church offices, the Meeting Room, Toilets, Kitchen, Visitor Lounge, etc.
- b) The janitor in charge shall make sure that all the equipment necessary for janitor tasks are available in good condition for church member to perform the work.
- c) The Janitor In charge shall assign weekly or monthly cleaning duties to church members with proper instruction.
- d) The janitor in charge needs to review all the janitor-related equipment and can buy if necessary for below \$50 value and re-imburse from the Finance Department.

SECTION 4: Responsibilities of Campus Monitor

- a) He/She shall have access to Church CCTV and monitor on a regular basis.
- b) He/She shall have control of Church Campus Air Conditioner and ensure that it is function as required.
- c) As a Campus monitor, he/she can call 911 in case of any issue which is related to church with outside threat or accident in the premises.
- d) The Campus Monitor shall ensure that all the church property is up to date and if any property needs repair or needs purchase, he needs to report it to the church staff or Church Executive.

SECTION 5: Responsibilities of Gas, Water, and Electric

- a) This responsibility shall be given to a person who has good knowledge in all the related issue to Gas, Water and Electric.
- b) In charge shall ensure that Gas, Water and Electric safety rules are followed by Church members.
- c) In charge person shall perform overall monthly review and if any issue found, he shall report it to the church staff for repair or replacement.

SECTION 6: Responsibilities of Parking in charge

- a) Parking in charge ensures that all vehicles are given proper direction for parking in the right parking lot on all occasions in the church campus.
- b) In charge shall assign parking duties to church members on any given day if needed.
- c) In charge ensure that all the parking duty personnel shall always wear safety uniform.
- d) In Charge shall inform church staff or Church Monitor in case of any vehicle accidents occur in the church premises.

SECTION 7: Church Custodian/Caretaker

The Church Caretaker shall be responsible for the upkeep and supervision of the church and its campus. This includes maintaining the cleanliness, safety, and orderly condition of all church properties and facilities. The caretaker may also be assigned additional duties from time to time by the Lead Pastor and the Executive Body. *See PBC's Policy No.8 for detailed responsibilities*

ARTICLE XII Records and Reports

The Church shall maintain the following records and reports: (a) correct books and records of accounts (financial records), (b) written minutes of the proceedings of its membership and Church Executive meetings, (c) the membership rolls specified in ARTICLE V, SECTION 3 of these Bylaws, which rolls shall set forth the members' names and addresses, (d) contribution statements for contributors, (e) property record.

All such records shall be kept at the Church's principal's office. The Church may also maintain any other records as may from time to time be deemed necessary or useful in the pursuit of its purposes.

Any Member of the Church may inspect the records (reports from completed quarterly cycles) of the Church within normal business hours, in the offices of the Church, upon written request delivered to the lead pastor of the church. The written request shall state the time at which inspection is desired and shall be delivered to the lead pastor at least five (5) business days prior to the proposed date of inspection. Copies of any disclosed records of the Church shall be made available to the Member upon payment of a reasonable charge per page for such copies. However, individual records of contributions and personnel records shall be confidential and not subject to disclosure.

ARTICLE XIII Construction and Definition

Unless the context requires otherwise, Oklahoma law shall govern the construction of these Bylaws.

ARTICLE XIV AMENDMENTS

A. Amendments to the Bylaws

These Bylaws, or any part thereof, may be altered, amended, or repealed, and/or new Bylaws may be adopted, by a vote of two-thirds majority of the Members present at any special or regular membership meeting called according to ARTICLE VI, SECTION 4 hereof, at which a quorum is present.

B. Amendments to the Church Policies

Church policies may be amended by the Executive Body through a simple majority vote and shall be forwarded to the General Body for approval at the Annual or Half-Yearly General Meeting.

POLICIES

Peniel Baptist Church, located in Tulsa, Oklahoma, USA, has adopted church policies that cover various areas of ministry and administration. These policies may be amended as deemed necessary by the church executive, subject to approval by a simple majority vote at the next annual or half-yearly assembly.

NO. 1: FINANCE POLICY

Section 1: Introduction

Designated Funds: Designated funds, including love offerings, are funds that are designated to a specific use and are not given to support the church's budget. All other funds shall be used for the support of the church's budget. The budget serves as a guideline for anticipated expenditures for the upcoming year. Approval of the budget is an approval of these projected expenditures with the understanding that actual funds must be available in the church's funds at the time of purchase. The person responsible for each line item must ensure that all expenditure is in line with the following guidelines, which govern the collection and administration of all church funds.

Section 2: PBC Finance Team/Committee

The Finance Team shall consist of not less than three (3) and not more than 5 members approved by the congregation. They shall be responsible in seeing that all monies are received, accounted, disbursed, and reported according to guidelines established in the church Policy Manual. When called upon, the Finance Team shall make recommendation to the church executive/body concerning purchases and expenditures.

The Finance Team shall prepare the annual budget of the church as directed by the church Policy Manual. This Team shall coordinate with the church finance secretary/accountant and tellers who are responsible in counting, recording, and depositing all receipts as directed by the policy manual.

The finance secretary shall be the head of the finance team.

Section 3: Guidelines

The oversight of the finances of the church is primarily the responsibility of the church Finance and/or Assistant Finance. He/She will work in cooperation with all those who have financial responsibilities within the church, especially the Finance, Auditors, and Church Executive as defined in the church bylaws. The finance shall be assisted by the Assistant finance.

All budgeted expenditures must be in keeping with the purchase order system of the church.

Section 4: Purchase order system

- a) Items that are fixed budget will not require a purchase order. Fixed budget items will be

defined as:

- b) Salaries and allowances
- c) Utilities and insurance
- d) Contingency fund (until balance =2,000)
- e) BGCO & TMBN funds
- f) Debt payments/mortgage, etc.
- g) payments
- h) All other expenditures require a purchase order.
- i) All purchase orders less than \$100 must be submitted to the Church Finance within five business days of purchase.
- j) All purchases equal to or exceeding \$500, must be authorized by the finance controlling officer (FCO)/Pastor prior to purchase.
- k) All budgeted expenditures that would result in the overspending of any line item must be presented to the Finance Team and approved by the church executive prior to commitment.
- l) Purchase orders will then be given to the finance; the finance will then take to the FCO (pastor) for approval and then the purchase order will be executed as requested.
- m) All purchase orders must include the amount of the purchase, the party to which the check is to be written, the line item(s) to which the purchase is to be charged, the signature(s) of the person(s) designated as responsible for each of those line items, and the date of purchase before being submitted.
- n) Availability of funds will be determined by the Church finance in conjunction with the finance team.

Section 5: Meetings

The Finance secretary of the church will meet as needed with the Finance Team and those responsible for Budget requests to review expenditures. The purpose of these meetings will be to promote and develop a better coordination and cooperation between all parties and church approved financial guidelines.

Section 6: Designated Funds

All designated funds raised or donated to our church shall be received and recorded by the finance secretary of the church. Expenditures of designated funds are governed by the appropriate team. Expenditures from designated accounts do not require additional approval.

Section 7: Love (Designated) Offerings

Love offerings will only be received towards mission related funds and charity upon the prior approval of the church executive.

Section 8: Contingency Fund Expenditure

Expenditures from the Contingency Fund will require the recommendation of the Finance Team and the church executive approval. Once the expenditure has been made, the church will

begin to replenish the fund to reach its minimum required balance of \$5,000. The repayment rate will be set by the church body.

Section 9: Excess Receipts

All monies more than the established total church budget of each year will be given to Debt Retirement if a mortgage exists. This does not include any designated offerings.

Section 10: Budget preparation

- a) An annual budget shall be prepared by the finance team for recommendation to the church executive for adoption according to the following procedures:
- b) Budget requests for the coming fiscal year should be received by November 30 of the current fiscal year.
- c) The Finance Team will review and compile a proposed budget by the last Sunday of November.
- d) The proposed budget will be given to the church executive for review.
- e) If the Finance Team is asked to review the proposed budget, once that review is complete the Finance Team will then make the budget available to the congregation for review at least 10 days prior to the church business session.
- f) The Finance Team, in conjunction with the church executive will set aside time for a question and answer period for the proposed budget, possibly before December 15.

Section 11: Collection, Counting, and Deposit of Funds

- a) Finance secretaries or ushers are responsible for collecting tithes and offerings during and after services.
- b) Collected offerings are brought to the counter/tellers in the finance office.
- c) Not less than two people should count the money.
- d) No spouse or family members should count the money together.
- e) The Finance Secretary is responsible to deposit the money to the bank.
- f) No offerings should be kept in hands for more than two days after receiving it.

Section 12: Benevolence Policies – In-House – Church Members

- a) Disbursing benevolence is the sole responsibility of the church executive. Thus, any requests for benevolence shall be made to the church executive through finance secretary.
- b) Approval of the request for benevolence funds shall be depending on the availability of funds.
- c) A report of benevolence activities shall be given, by the finance team, to the church regular business sessions, and upon the request to the church executive at their regular meetings.
- d) Any benevolence gift of \$1000 and above to one individual or family, must be approved by the joint committee of the church, depending on the availability of funds.
- e) There will be a non-church member limit of \$300.00.

Section 13: Membership Benefits

Any or every Church member will have the privilege to enjoy membership benefits based on the following conditions set up by the Church.

- a) The church shall have a Felicitation program for church members who earned a degree/graduation ceremony in any field of training from high school and above on Students Sunday every year with a gift of \$150/- only per head.
- b) Any PBC youth member who will be having a holy marriage program will get financial assistance of \$1,000/- from the church's charity fund. Eligibility to receive this cash assistance is to be a full member of the church for at least a year and have contributed faithfully to the church in every way he/she can.
- c) Any new member will be welcome to the church with a membership certificate.

Section 14: Condolences

- a) Any full member of the church who experienced a loss (death) within the family (church member) is entitled to get a sum of \$6000 from the church's funeral fund. The church will give a sum of \$200 as condolence to the bereaved family (HY assembly July 7, 2024 *Resln. 7*).
- b) To achieve Sec. 14 a) the church funeral fund project, each member must contribute \$50/- per head in each financial year.
- c) Each member of the church must pay tithes and other donations faithfully and regularly to sustain and enhance the functions and ministry of the church.
- d) To be eligible for Sec. 14 a) any member who barely takes part in contributing \$50/head toward funeral fund in the church (PBC) has no right to claim Section 14 a) in any case.

Section 15: Audits

Internal Audit - The financial records of the church shall be audited half-yearly. The Audit Team shall consist of 3 members arranged by the church body and shall make a half-yearly audit of all books and accounts of the church and report to the church the results of the audit. The report of the previous financial year should be made in the 1st quarter church business meeting.

Instructions (guidelines) for auditors:

INCOME:

- a) Make sure all income has receipt.
- b) Cross-check income receipts with income entry in the cash register to determine the correct amount of income is entered (Check for income receipt number, date, amount, source/particulars, etc.).
- c) Make sure the finance in charge has updated the files on a regular basis.

EXPENDITURE:

- a) Make sure every expenditure has voucher support
- b) In case of no original voucher, look for Actual Payee Receipt (APR) duly signed by the payee and countersigned by the Finance Controlling Officer (FCO) or Lead Pastor.
- c) Compare itemized expenditure entries in the cash register with the expenditure voucher

- (Date, amount, voucher number, etc.).
- d) Make sure the finances have followed the approved budget. To determine that, compare the overall itemized expenditure with the head wise annual budget for expenditure.
 - e) Check for Bank balance, cash in hand, overall balance in total.

PROPERTY RECORD:

- a) Auditors should also audit the church property and give a report on list of damages or newly purchased property.
- b) They should find out current list of church property and where they are at (if possible).

NO. 2: ELECTION POLICY OF THE CHURCH

The church, as a corporate body, shall hold elections for positions within the church as necessary, based on the policies adopted by the church.

Section 1: Officers of the Election

- a) The Meeting chairman shall serve as a presiding officer.
- b) The Recording Secretary shall be a returning officer.
- c) There shall be volunteers appointed by the assembly to assist the presiding and returning officers in distributing, collecting ballots, and counting the votes.

Section 2: Term of the Election

- a) All elected posts shall have a three-year term, unless elected to fill in a position open due to resignation or an unexpected incident unfolding.
- b) There shall be an election for every elected post at the end of the term unless there are new positions created, or any position stays vacant for any reason. The election procedures are as follows.

Section 3: Procedures of the Election

- a) The procedures of the election are as follows
- b) The Presiding officer has the overall authority during the election
- c) The Presiding officer shall not vote in the election but can break a tie between candidates.
- d) All elections shall be conducted with a secret ballot.
- e) Any candidate shall have a proposal and seconded, unless proposed by the church executive.
- f) One individual should not be elected for more than one major position (department head)
- g) Eligible candidates will be members who are present and who are on leave granted by the assembly.
- h) Any full member of the church shall have the right to propose and seconded a candidate.

Section 4: Election of the Church Executive; See also Article X Sec. 2 (A)

Church Executive is the executive body (committee) of the church that consists of the Lead

Pastor, Assistant Pastor, Mission Chairman, Men Chairman, Women Chairperson, Youth Chairman, and Finance Secretary. Co-op Christian Education Minister, Worship Leader, Technical Director, Fellowship Minister (in-charge).

- a) Church Executive can be elected all at once and later assign position or elect for each position.
- b) The lead pastor position remains unelected position (appointed post) until changes are made.
- c) The existing Church Executive shall arrange proposed list for the church executive for the new term that should not need a seconded but should not exceed more than 50% of the existing members.
- d) There shall (can) be a proposal and seconded for any position from the floor.
- e) Men chairman, women chairperson, and youth chairman shall (can) be elected by the departments and submit to the church executive.
- f) The election shall be done by a secret ballot.

Section 5: Election of the Department Leaders/Committee

All departments shall have their election done prior to the last PBC staff meeting in the election year and submit their report to the church executive through the lead pastor for further action at the staff meeting and general assembly (meetings).

- a) All departments should have a minimum of three and a maximum of five committee members.
- b) There shall be a Proposal and seconded for each position.
- c) Election shall be done by a secret ballot.
- d) Section 6: Selection & approval of Worship/Media team
- e) Worship team and media team has no term limit.
- f) Selection shall be done by individual commitment
- g) The team leader has the sole authority to select individuals based on their skills/talent.
- h) Those selected team members shall be reported to the church executive for approval.

NO. 3: PBC APPOINTMENT & TERMINATION POLICY

The church has adopted a policy in relation to appointment of new workers/staffs, and also the church at the same time has a termination policy for workers/staffs.

Section 1: Appointment Policy

The following points need to be considered by the committee and the candidate.

- a) Any appointment of new worker/staff/missionary shall be carried out by adopting a resolution at the church general body meeting.
- b) Calling an application for the open position (s) shall be done by the lead pastor.
- c) Lead Pastor can propose a candidate, but the Church Executive shall approve the proposal.
- d) Any applicant shall fill out an application form and submit the same with his/her resume including personal testimony to the lead pastor.

- e) The church Executive is the sole responsible body to appoint and remove PBC paid staffs and missionaries.
- f) Personal Interview with the candidate(s) shall be held in the nearest meeting of the Church Executive following the application date line.
- g) Lead Pastor shall give an official appointment letter along with job offer letter to the candidate who is selected for the position by the Church Executive.

Section 2: Termination or Dismissal Policy (See By-law art. IX sec. 3)

An active PBC workers/staffs who is found guilty on the following ground may be terminated by the Church Executive subject to approval of the assembly.

- a) Immorality
- b) Breach of PBC Faith statement
- c) Breach of service rules that is protected in the PBC By-law
- d) Found guilty of involvement in any illegal conduct
- e) The job performance of any paid and unpaid staff/worker shall be evaluated at the end of every financial year.
- f) Based on the evaluation, any employee/pay worker staff member of the church is liable for explanation call, suspend, or termination of employment at any time by the church Core Committee/Church Executive.
- g) If anyone (paid/unpaid) is suspended from his/her position, his /her suspension shall not be revoked until he/she shows a genuine makeover of his/her mistake in the past.
- h) If anyone (paid/unpaid) is terminated from his/her position, he/she shall not be qualified to hold any position in the church until he/she shows a genuine makeover of his/her mistake in the past.
- i) Any fulltime or part time missionary can be dismissed if there is any breach of service rules that is protected by the PBC mission policy.

Section 3: Pay & Allowances

- a) Any/every pay PBC staff(s) shall be paid hourly/lumpsum every other week or monthly after reviewing his/her working day report, but not later than the 5th of the following month.
- b) The amount of pay for any PBC staff shall be set by the church executive base on the position and the job description.
- c) PBC Missionary Pay will be arranged based on their posting and their job description.
- d) Any worker/staff shall be given bonus based on their performance at the job they are assigned to.
- e) Worker's pay (Full time or part time) shall be raised by 15% of his/her net basic annually, if the worker achieved/shows a commendable job performance.
- f) For missionary salary the church executive will set the amount of pay place, currency, and condition of sponsorship, and the same shall be approved by the assembly.
- g) Allowances shall be arranged if the Pastoral Team considers it important.
- h) The following table shows example for the missionary pay.

Full-time

Sl. No.	Name of Missionary	Place of work	Pay scale	Incre.	Net Basic	Med.	Housing	Gross
1	Mr.	Tamu	\$180-300	15%NB	\$200			\$200

Partnership/contract basis

Sl. No.	Name of Missionary	Place of work	Pay scale	Incre.	Net Basic	Med.	Housing	Gross
1	Mr.	Tamu	\$90-150	10%NB	\$110			\$110

Note: This shall remain in effect until amended by the Assembly

Section 4: Worker's Tithe

All PBC workers/staffs including missionaries are expected to give their tithe to the church regularly.

Section 5: Leave Rules:

- All Full-time PBC workers shall have the following leave rules:
- Casual leave for 13 days a year and not more than four consecutive days at a time.
- Earn leave shall be 30 days a year, and another 30 days with half pay if the situation demands.
- Maternity and special leave shall be 60 days a year, and another 60 days with half pay if the situation demands.
- Leave rule for a partnership/contract missionary must be the same as full-time missionary unless the partner mission agency/church has their own leave rules.

Section 6: Working Days:

- Any Full-time PBC workers are required to engage in Church/mission activities for a minimum of 16 days a month or 35 hours a week.
- Every PBC staff shall submit their working day report in writing to the Church Executive through the pastor.
- For PBC missionary, each missionary should submit their working day report in writing to the Pastor, copy to the mission secretary at the end of every month before the pay roll is finalized.
- All PBC missionaries shall give a brief report of their mission activities in writing half-yearly to the Pastor, copy to mission secretary.
- Failing to comply with the above point may lead to withholding of the missionary pay.

Section 7: Pension/Retirement/Benefit

PBC has no benefit scheme for staffs; Housing, medical, childcare, emergency funds, etc. cannot

be set in advance. It should be considered according to the need that arises and based on a request made by the beneficiary written with documents proof.

Section 8: Evaluation of staffs/workers

- a) The Evaluation of PBC staffs/workers and their works shall be done on a yearly basis, and if any substandard activities found, the Church Executive shall take necessary action.
- b) There will incentives each year for any distinguish worker/staff on the recommendation of the department concern.
- c) The Church Executive shall have the final authority for the dismissal/replacement of any worker who does not meet the required standard as a worker or breaking the employee rules. (*See Policy 3, Section 2*)

NO. 4: LICENTIAE CANDIDACY, REQUIREMENTS, AND PASTOR ORDINATION PROCEDURES

Section 1: Licentiate Candidacy, Requirements

- a) Anyone committed to serve in full time ministry and desiring to apply for Licentiate candidacy must have the following:
- b) He must be born again and have a commendable testimony within and outside the church.
- c) He must be spiritually mature (He should not be a new believer).
- d) He must be fully committed to the church ministry and actively involves in whatever ways he can.
- e) He must have a strong and right standing on the Biblical doctrines.
- f) He must be a theological graduate from a reputed theological college/have any diploma in ministry and/or theological college.
- g) He must be someone committed and ready to enter full time ministry in the church or someone the church has decided to employ as pastor. He can also be someone committed to go for missionary within and outside the country.
- h) He must be a member of the church for a minimum of two years.

Section 2: Procedures for Licentiate Confirmation & Ordination

- a) The candidate must submit a written application to the Lead Pastor copy to other members of the Core Committee along with necessary documents.
- b) The Core Committee shall do a comprehensive background study of the candidate (s) and gather all required supporting documents. After having careful deliberation on the matter and a consensus agreement of the Core Committee to proceed with the ordination process, the matter shall be put forward to the Church Executive for further action.
- c) The Church Executive, on receiving recommendations from the Core Committee shall forward the matter to the assembly for final approval. The assembly shall vote on the matter, if 2/3 of the members voted in favor of the candidate, the assembly must propose a date to confer Licentiate Pastor for the candidate.
- d) From the date of conferring licentiate pastor, the lead pastor shall be responsible in supervising and training the candidate for practical ministry for a minimum of one year Probation.

- e) After a year of probation, the lead pastor shall give a report and recommendation of the candidate to the Church Executive. Based on the recommendation of the lead pastor, the Church Executive shall decide the (Date & time) for ordination of the candidate.
- f) The ordination shall be officiated by the lead/assistant pastor of the local church in the presence of the congregational members.

Section 3: Pastor/Reverend Ordination:

Ordination is the official recognition of the local church that God has called and gifted a man for service in that church, accompanied by their commission to advance the cause of Christ. It is the responsibility of each local church to recognize the man or men God has called to serve Him in that place, to set them apart for ministry, to safeguard the ministry, and to provide an occasion that will encourage them in years to come. Therefore, someone who seek to get Pastor ordination shall have the following qualifications.

- a) He must be born again and have a commendable testimony within and outside the church.
- b) He must be spiritually mature (He should not be a new believer).
- c) He must be fully committed to the church ministry and actively involves in whatever ways he can.
- d) He must have a strong and right standing on the Biblical doctrines.
- e) He must be a theological graduate with a document proof from a reputed theological college/have any diploma in ministry and/or theological college.
- f) He must have a document to prove that he has been in ministry with a minimum of three years in the field of Christian/church ministries.
- g) He must be someone committed and ready to enter full time ministry in the church or someone the church has decided to employ as pastor. He can also be someone committed to go for missionary within and outside the country.
- h) He must obtain a recommendation (NOC) from his mother church.
- i) He must be a member of the church for a minimum of two years.

Section 4: Procedures for Pastor/Reverend Ordination

- a) The candidate must submit a written application to the Lead Pastor copy to other members of the Core Committee along with necessary documents.
- b) The Core Committee shall do a comprehensive background study of the candidate (s) and gather all required supporting documents. After having careful deliberation on the matter and a consensus agreement of the Core Committee to proceed with the ordination process, the matter shall be put forward to the Church Executive for further action.
- c) The Church Executive, on receiving recommendations from the Core Committee shall forward the matter to the assembly for final approval. The assembly shall vote on the matter, if 2/3 of the members vote in favor of the candidate, the assembly must propose a date for the ordination of the candidate.
- d) The ordination shall be officiated by the lead/assistant pastor of the local church in the presence of the congregational members.

No. 5: PBC MISSION POLICY/MISSIONARY MANUAL

PBC Missions Department has adopted its mission policy, that includes every important aspect of the department and its mission activities within and abroad.

Section 1: Scope

This policy shall be applied to any or every missionary who are sponsor by Peniel Baptist Church as full-time missionary or partnership missionary.

Section 2: Area of Operation

The area of operation for missionary activity of Peniel Baptist Church will not have any regional restriction, hence this manual shall be globally applicable wherever the mission work is carried out by the organization/church.

Section 3: Objectives of Mission

- a) To witness the Gospel of Jesus Christ as an obedient to the Great Commission of Jesus Christ.
- b) To ascertain the spiritual growth and maturity of new believers.
- c) To equip and give adequate training to new believers for effective mission engagement.
- d) To identify compatible and like-minded mission agencies or churches or ministries for partnership ministry.
- e) To acquire movable or immovable assets for the furtherance of the gospel.
- f) The ultimate purpose of the mission is to plant a church; however, the planted church on its maturity should be handed over to the mainline churches located in its locality.

Section 4: Officers of the Department

Mission Chairman: The department shall have a mission minister elected by the assembly who should be in-charge of the overall functions of the department and its missionary activities.

Section 5: Power & Functions of Mission Department

Peniel Baptist Church Mission Department shall have the following power and functions to facilitate the most appropriate and successful mission activities.

- a) The Mission department shall have a minimum of three members to function as a department committee to be led by the mission minister.
- b) To propose the recruitment and expulsion of missionary to the Church assembly.
- c) To propose pay raise, allowance, and gift for the missionaries.
- d) To propose any project related to mission works.
- e) To organize, sponsor, and facilitate spiritual activities for the church, Missionary training, conference, camps, and department meetings.
- f) To prepare an annual budget for the department that needs to be approved by the assembly.
- g) To raise donations/funds from individuals, churches, or organizations to accomplish the

department project.

Section 6: Categories of PBC Missionaries

- a) Full time Missionary: Is appointed by the pastoral team and approved by the annual assembly.
- b) Partnership Missionary: Is a missionary partly sponsor by PBC in collaboration with other partnering agency/churches.

Section 7: Salaries of Missionaries

Missionary salary will be set/fixed by the church executive and approved by the assembly according to place, currency, and condition of sponsorship. *See Policy 3 Section 3.*

Section 8: Qualifications of Missionaries:

- a) Must be born again Christian who exhibit a daily holy Christian living.
- b) Should have a clear calling and commitment to serve the Lord and have a strong burden and compassion for the lost.
- c) Shall be well equipped for the ministry and have a sound biblical knowledge.
- d) Should be ready to face challenges in ministry and persevering in all circumstances.
- e) Should have a minimum degree of Diploma in ministry from a reputed theological college. Preference will be given candidate holding a degree of Bachelor of Theology (B.Th.) or higher from a recognized institution well accepted by the church.

Section 9: Missions Funds and Financial Head

- a) Mission sponsor fund
- b) ME BOX
- c) Faith Promise & Fund Raising.

Section 9: Term of contract

- a) The PBC Missionaries whether it be full-time, or partnership shall be on a contract basis for a period of three years and should be renewed every three years. The renewal of the contract should be based on the missionary's performance during the contract with reference to article 15.
- b) Any intending PBC missionary shall be appointed for one year probationary. The pastoral team shall confirm his/her appointment for three years contract based on the recommendation of the Mission Department.
- c) Orientation shall be given by the Mission Department within the first week of joining the job.

Section 10: Fund Raising Rules

- a) No full-time missionary shall not work in partnership with other churches, organizations, and mission agencies.

- b) No missionary shall in any case raise funds without obtaining permission from the PBC Pastoral Team.

NO. 6: RULES FOR B1/B2 & F1/F2 VISA

Section 1: Tourist (B1B2) Visa

- a) The church can invite people (VIP) preacher/resource person/guest etc. for any special event of the church. This shall/can be carried out by adopting a resolution in the Church
- b) Executive meeting. (Houbung in special event a ding a ngaichat, apoimo ho kou thei hiding, Church Executive phatsah (kilol) na a kou hiding.
- c) Church member can invite their family members and relatives through the church, and the member shall be responsible for the invited individual (Church member insung mi le kinaipi US a hung kholjin nom ho dinga lampi sem a kou thei hiding. Amopo church member in ijakai akivetsui ding).

Section 2: Student (F1/F2) Visa

- a) The church can extend help in any way possible to individual willing to pursue higher studies in Tulsa, USA who will be beneficial for the church and community. That individual should have someone in the church to host him/her during his/her stay in the US. (Koitobang US a lekhasim nom'a khonunga gam le nam chule Houbung a dinga miphachom ding ho kithopi thei hiding, ahin houbung miho lah a availhun ding mi neiho hiding).
- b) That individual shall write an application to the church executive addressed to the Lead Pastor. The lead pastor shall bring the matter to the church executive meeting for decision (Amasapen'a lead pastor address bol'a kithopi angaichat na thu a thumna lekha ahin sut ding, Lead pastor in Church Executive kom'a thulhuh sem thei na ding a alhut ding ahi).
- c) Upon the acceptance of the application by the Church Executive, he/she should fill out and sign consent form and then only the church should take the matter forward (Boipi thei dinga CE in pha asah hon Church in asem consent form ahin suh dim uva anop na soi ahin peh teng ule boipi pan hiding ahi).
- d) Apart from the Church Executive adopting a resolution and agreed to help an individual based on the above three points, using any church document to invite any individual is strictly prohibited (Church Executive in kilolna alah a boipi ding a phatsah ho ti lou koiman ama cham'a houbung lekha mangcha a mi akou thei lou ding ahi).
- e) Any individual coming Tulsa US for studies through this proper channel will be eligible for help in any/every way possible from the church members, but any finance related needs shall be taken care by him/herself (Hitobang a kithopina bolpeh dinga CE in pha ana sah ho houbung le houbung miten akhoh na chan le jo chan a kiboipi ding ahi. Hinla sum-le-pai lutna jouse ama cham'a akimopoh ding ahi).
- f) Individual coming to Tulsa for studies through PBC shall enjoy up to two months of apartment rent by the church. Once he/she settled he/she shall take care everything including pay back the rent money by installment/one-time payment within a year (Amaho tobang chu houbung in apartment rent bol'a ama kiman dungjuiya lhakhat/lhani houbung in vetkol na nei thei hi ding, ahung kiti thei teng leijakai acham a akibol diu

achunga kisulut sum-le-pai chu installment/one-time payment a kum khat sunga asah ding ahi).

NO.7: RELIGIOUS WORKER VISA

Section 1: Religious Worker (R-1) Application Requirements & Procedures

- a) Religious worker candidates should be considered based on membership seniority.
- b) The Candidate's moral conduct and commitment shall be strictly evaluated.
- c) The candidate must be born again and fully committed in the church ministry.
- d) The candidate must be fully committed to the church ministry and actively involves in whatever ways he can.
- e) The candidate must have a minimum of/at least two years of membership in the church.
- f) The Church Executive shall strictly consider the candidate commitment to God and to the Church (PBC) ministries.
- g) The candidate who is potential candidate for lead or assistant pastor must have a theological degree acceptable by the church along with the requirement of the USCIS.
- h) Any eligible candidate must give a written application to the Pastoral team through the lead pastor.
- i) The Church Executive shall have a detailed discussion and deliberation about the application. Upon the approval of the application, the applicant must fill out a consent form and give a consent signature and submit to the Church Executive through the lead pastor and the lead pastor shall be responsible for overseeing the application process.
- j) Any Religious Worker (R-1) candidate whose application (I-797) is approved must continue in the church ministries for a minimum of five years.
- k) The Church Executive shall be overall in-charge or responsible for any religious worker (R-1) visa issue (matter). The Church Executive shall be responsible for making decisions for the best of all with respect to the said matter without the assembly approval.

NO. 8: CHURCH CARETAKER

Section 1: Introduction

The Church Caretaker position is one of the most important positions in the church. This position is filled by appointment, not election, for a minimum one-year term, unless changes are made due to unavoidable circumstances. Caretaker appointment shall be done by the church Executive, just as with other positions. *See Policy 3, section 1.*

Section 2: Duties and Responsibilities of Caretaker

A church caretaker is responsible for maintaining the cleanliness, safety, and functionality of church buildings and grounds. This includes cleaning, minor repairs, event setup and teardown, and ensuring the facility is presentable for services and activities. They may also handle tasks such as yard work, waste management, and basic equipment maintenance.

Section 2(a): Cleaning and Maintenance:

- 1) Routine cleaning: Sweeping, mopping, vacuuming, dusting, and sanitizing all areas, including restrooms, kitchen, sanctuary, classrooms, and offices, emptying trash and recycling bins and ensuring proper disposal.
- 2) Minor repairs: Changing light bulbs, fixing minor plumbing issues, repairing or replacing fixtures, and other small tasks or report to the concern person.
- 3) Grounds maintenance: Keeping the exterior of the church clean and tidy, including mowing lawns, removing litter, and clearing leaves.

Section 2 (b): Facility Safety and Security:

Checking for safety hazards, ensuring doors and windows are locked, and reporting any maintenance needs. Ensuring that equipment is in good working order and reporting any malfunctions. Adhering to fire safety regulations and other safety guidelines.

NO.9: WEDDING

This policy establishes the guidelines for weddings conducted by the church, outlining the scope of the church's responsibilities and involvement. It identifies two types of wedding arrangements to ensure clarity and proper conduct of all ceremonies.

a) Church-Coordinated Wedding

In this type of wedding, the church takes full responsibility for organizing and conducting the ceremony. This includes planning, coordination, and oversight of all wedding activities held within the church premises. The church ensures that all religious, procedural, and administrative requirements are met, and the wedding is conducted under its full guidance. All church-owned properties required for the wedding shall be provided free of charge. However, the church shall not be responsible for wedding-related financial expenses, except for the cash assistance provided as stipulated in Policy No. 1, Section 13-b.

b) Church as Participating Body Only

In this type of wedding, the church serves only as a participant in the ceremony. The primary responsibility for planning and organizing, including venue selection for the wedding, rests with the couple or external organizers. The church's role is limited to participation in the religious aspects, including priestly ministry, of the ceremony and does not include responsibility for coordination, logistics, or overall event management. However, all church-owned properties required for the wedding shall be provided free of charge if the wedding is held within the church premises.

NO.9 :PASTORAL MANUAL

The Peniel Baptist Church has adopted a manual for pastoral ministry, which any minister should understand and follow this manual any time and every time they officiate any formal procedure in(of) the church.

SECTION 1: Baptism

Baptism is an English word taken from Greek word *baptismos*, which mean emersion/emerge in the water that signifies the death and resurrection of our Lord Jesus Christ.

“Jesus answered, “Most assuredly, I say to you, unless one is born of water and the Spirit, he cannot enter the kingdom of God” (John 3:5). “He who believes and is baptized will be saved; but he who does not believe will be condemned” (Mark 16:16). We can see several verses about baptism in the Bible (Matt. 3:1-11; 1 Cor. 10:2; Ge. 6:5-7, 7:1-24; Acts 2:41)

- 1) Church member who is willing to testify his/her faith in Christ by water baptism should be given baptism counseling ahead of baptism service.
- 2) The person willing to take baptism (if adult) should give his/her consent to the Church Executive by him/herself; but if a minor by parent/guardian and the Church Executive shall arrange appropriate time for baptism counseling and baptism service.
- 3) The minister officiating the baptism service should give pre-baptism counseling to ascertain the person’s faith in Christ and genuineness in willing to follow Christ.
- 4) Baptism should be an emersion baptism, not sprinkling or pouring.
- 5) The officiating minister shall pronounce the following lines while baptizing the believers.
- 6) Mr./Miss/Mrs. _____ as/since you testify your faith in Christ Jesus and accept Him as your personal savior and Lord, I baptized you in the name of the God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit. May the goodness of our Lord shine upon you now and forever, Amen.

SECTION 2: Sendoff Ceremony

(Gen. 24:1-67; Prov. 12:4, 14:1, 31:10-31; Ruth 1:16-18)

Sendoff ceremony as a part of Christian way of marrying off a daughter to her betrothed husband to build up a Christian home and fulfill God’s plan in one’s life.

The minister should be an ordained pastor. The event can be organized inside/outside the church or if the family wants to rent a hall it will be up to the choice of the family.

Minister shall read from scripture portion and give a brief exhortation and offer a blessing prayer for the brides to be in the name of God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit.

SECTION 3: Holy Marriage

Marriage is instituted by God (Gen. 1:28). “He who finds a wife finds a good thing and obtains favor from the LORD” (Prov. 18:22). And the LORD God said, “*It is not good that man should be alone; I will make him a helper comparable to him.*”

A Christian should marry a Christian and not to a non-Christian. Do not be unequally yoked together with unbelievers. For what ^[a]fellowship has righteousness with lawlessness? And what ^[b]communion has light with darkness? (2 Cor. 6:14)

Pastor should conduct a pre-marital counselling for the couple and make sure they are well informed about what a Christian marriage should be, help them to accept one another in the love of God (unconditional love).

Questions to the groom and bride.

To the Groom:

Pastor: _____ will you take _____ to be your lawful wedded wife, to live together according to God's Holy law in the state of marriage?

Groom: Yes, I will

Pastor: Do you promise to be true to her in health and in sickness, in riches and in poor, in good times and in bad times to love, to honor, and take good care of her?

Groom: Yes, I do.

Pastor: Do you promise to be a faithful husband to her as long you both shall live?

Groom: Yes, I do

To the Bride:

Pastor: _____ will you take _____ to be your lawful wedded husband, to live together according to God's Holy law in the state of marriage?

Bride: Yes, I will

Pastor: Do you promise to be true to him in health and in sickness, in riches and in poor, in good times and in bad times to love, to honor, and take good care of him?

Bride: Yes, I do.

Pastor: Do you promise to be a faithful wife to him as long you both shall live?

Bride: Yes, I do

Marriage Pledge:

The couple shall hold their right hands together and say,

Groom: I _____ take you _____ from this day forward, to be my lawful wedded wife, to have and to hold, for better, for worse, for richer, for poorer, in sickness and in health, to love and cherish according to God's holy law till death do us part; and to this I pledge myself before God.

Bride: I _____ take you _____ from this day forward, to be my lawful wedded husband, to have and to hold, for better, for worse, for richer, for poorer, in sickness and in health, to love and cherish according to God's holy law till death do us part; and to this I pledge myself before God. ***Lose hands.***

Dedication of Ring: Best man give the rings to pastor and Pastor shall dedicate the ring before he gave it to them.

Groom: I give you this ring as a symbol of our marriage in the name of God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit. With my body I honor you, what I am I give to you, what I have I share with you, Amen.

Bride: I give you this ring as a symbol of our marriage in the name of God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit.

*Lighting Candle & signing marriage certificate and **blessing Prayer.***

Declaration of Marriage:

Groom and Bride holding their hands...

Mr. _____ and **Miss.** _____ have made their promises and pledged themselves to each other before God and their witnesses and have shown their consent by joining their hands and giving rings to one another. I, **Pastor** _____ declare in the name of God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit that they are husband and wife. Those whom God had joined together let no one put asunder, Amen.

Ladies and gentlemen, I present to you Mr. & Mrs. _____

SECTION 4: Holy Communion

(Matt. 26:26-29; 1 Cor. 11:23-34; Isaiah 53:28; Mark 14:20-25; Luke 22:17-20; John 6:4-56)

This Holy Communion is what Jesus had commanded us to celebrate as often as possible in remembrance of Him.

Matthew 26:26-29 And as they were eating, Jesus took bread, ^[a]blessed and broke it, and gave it to the disciples and said, “Take, eat; this is My body.” ²⁷ Then He took the cup, and gave thanks, and gave it to them, saying, “Drink from it, all of you. ²⁸ For this is My blood of the ^[b]new covenant, which is shed for many for the ^[c]remission of sins. ²⁹ But I say to you, I will not drink of this fruit of the vine from now on until that day when I drink it new with you in My Father’s kingdom.”

Who can Participate in Holy Communion?

Whoever believes in Jesus (born again) and took believer’s baptism can take part in the holy communion, but anyone under discipline should not/cannot participate in it. Moreover, anyone participating in it should examine himself/herself before partaking of the bread and wine (vine) (1 Cor. 11:27-32).

How to officiate the Holy Communion?

Pastor shall have a call for participation in the Lord’s table (holy communion), read related Bible passages and give a brief exhortation to the audience to meaningfully take part in the Lord’s table.

Pastor Should start with prayer and ends with prayer. The pastor can officiate this sacrament by himself (alone) or by asking help from other ordained pastor/among the elders.

Any officiating minister must make sure the congregation understands the purpose of the sacrament. They should be reminded of the sufferings, death, and resurrection of our Lord Jesus Christ.

The Lord Jesus on the same night in which He was betrayed took bread; and when He had given thanks, He broke it and said, “Take, eat; this is My body which is broken for you; do this in remembrance of Me.”

As the bread goes to the audience music can follow/pastor shall keep chanting “take this and eat, this is the bread that signifies the body of Jesus that is bruised and broken for us, eat in remembrance of Him.”

Note: The pastor can ask the congregation to take it, wait, and eat together, or first come first serve basis.

In the same manner, He also took the cup after supper, saying, “This cup is the new covenant in My blood. This does, as often as you drink *it*, in remembrance of Me.” For as often as you eat this bread and drink this cup, you proclaim the Lord’s death till He comes.

As the cup goes to the audience music can follow/pastor shall keep chanting “take this and drink, this is the vine/wine that signifies the blood of Jesus that cleansed us from all our sins, drink it in remembrance of Him.”

SECTION 5: Child Dedication

(Psalms 127:3; 1 Sam. 1:27-28; Luke 2:22-38; Matt. 19: 13-14; Mark 10:13-16; Luke 18:15-17)

_____ (baby’s name) As your (lawful) parents agreed and consent to dedicate you to the Lord, I pastor _____ (name) dedicate you in the name of God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit. May the goodness of God shine upon you now and forevermore, Amen.

SECTION 6: House Dedication

(Psalms 4:8, 122:7, 127:1; Prov. 24:3-4, 24:27; 2 Chron. 7:15-16; 1 Sam. 25:6; Matt. 7:24; Haggai 2:7; 2 Sam. 7:28-29; Isaiah 32:18; Hebrews 3:4; 1 Kings 8:13; Joshua 24:15)

When a church member gets a new home/house and plan to have housewarming program, he/she should give official notice to the Church Executive through the pastor. Church Executive with the home/house owner shall come together and schedule the detailed program.

Pastor will be an officiating minister in the program. He will read from scripture portion, give a brief exhortation speech, and do the dedication and blessing prayer for the home and owner.

Pastor: On this day of the Lord ___(M)___(D)___(Y), I _____ Pastor Peniel Baptist Church dedicated this home/house in the name of God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit. May the holy presence of the Lord indwell this house, and His love shines upon it now and forevermore, Amen. Close with blessing prayer.

SECTION 7: Funeral

(Eccl. &; Job 14:1-2; 19:25-27; Ps. 103:15-16; 23:4; 1 Cor 15:1-11, 15:40-44, 58; Phi 1:21; 2 Cor. 5:1-5; Rev. 14:13; Eccl. 3:2; Rom. 5:12; 1 Thess. 4:13-18)

In funeral service, pastor shall give a short and encouraging message for the bereaved family and the congregation. Take time to invoke the audience to be prepared for this unavoidable day each one is going to get into and finally give valediction to the mortal remains to be buried.

Our beloved _____ has experienced physical death and the dead body could no longer remain with us. Therefore, we lay down and bury this dead body to the grave to wait the return of Christ and to be resurrected with glory on the resurrection day, amen.

No. 10: AMENDMENT PROVISION

Any clause, phrase, or word, as well as policy matters, may be proposed by any department of PBC and can be submitted to the Church Executive for further deliberation. If the bill is passed in the CE meeting, the same shall be forwarded to the assembly for final approval or amendment with a simple majority.

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